

DIALOGUE — VINCENT + ABRAHAM

"The Social Media Pharisee"

Characters: **Caleb:** (The "Wannabe Influencer"). He uses "Gen-Z" slang poorly and is obsessed with his "image." **Seth:** (The "Straight-Talker"). He is unimpressed and speaks with a dry, deadpan wit.

[THE SCENE]

(Caleb is holding a phone/tablet, posing with an aggressive "peace sign" and a fake, blinding smile. Seth is watching him with a look of deep concern.)

CALEB: Hold on, Seth... almost got it. I need the lighting to say "I'm spiritually deep but also very approachable." It's for the workshop promo. #BlessedButRelatable.

SETH: You look like you have a toothache, Caleb.

CALEB: It's called "The Smize," Seth! You wouldn't get it. I'm building a brand here. When I walk into that workshop, I need the teens to think, "Wow, that guy has zero problems. I bet his Bible doesn't even have highlights because he already knows it all."

SETH: So your plan for a Christian workshop is to... pretend you aren't a human being?

CALEB: Exactly! I'm going for "Perfect Christian Role Model." I've even practiced my "I'm listening to your problems" face. *(He makes a ridiculous, overly serious face)* See? Compassion.

SETH: You look like you're trying to remember if you left the oven on. Look, 1 Samuel 16:7 is pretty clear. Man looks at the outward appearance—the "Smize," the Peace Sign, the expensive sneakers—but God looks at the heart.

CALEB: *(Dropping the pose)* Yeah, well, the heart doesn't get "likes," Seth.

SETH: No, it gets *lives*. Changed ones. You're so worried about looking like a finished statue that you're forgetting people can't relate to stone. They relate to scars. They relate to the guy who actually struggled with the verse he's teaching.

CALEB: *(Quietly)* But what if the "real me" is just... a guy who's still trying to figure it out? That's not a very good "brand."

SETH: It's the only brand that matters. Authenticity. God doesn't need your "Influencer" lighting, Caleb. He's the Light. He just needs you to be a window, not a billboard for yourself.

CALEB: *(Looks at his phone, then puts it in his pocket)* So... no #BlessedButRelatable?

SETH: How about #JustCaleb?

CALEB: *(Sighs)* Fine. But if I don't look cool, I'm blaming you.

SETH: *(Patting his shoulder)* Trust me, the bar is already pretty low. Let's go.